

beaches, mountains, villages, cities, rivers, lakes, deserts, jungles, or caves?

Once you have a list of two or three places you might like to try, head for the library. Tourist books tell about climate, language, altitude, food, visa requirements, and currency values. Encyclopedias cover history and politics, geography, religion, culture, and commerce. Check out nonfiction and, if you can find any, fiction by native and foreign authors who know the country. For more current information, read recent magazine and newspaper articles. If possible, get a copy of the English-language newspaper in the target country. The newspaper will cover current affairs and give you a feel for housing, things to do, and what's going on in the expatriate community.

In addition to going to the library, write or visit the country's nearest consulate. Most consulates have both tourist brochures and facts and figures for businesses.

Before you leave, ask people you know if they have friends or business associates living in the host country. Get their names and phone numbers and plan to call them when you arrive. You'll be amazed at how many of your friends know people in Tahiti and Barcelona. When Vicki and I moved to Buenos Aires, most people asked questions like, "Where is Argentina?" But every so often someone would have a cousin living there. By the time we were ready to move, we had over a dozen contacts.

When you arrive in the host country, whether for five weeks or five months, the rule is:

Live like a resident, not like a tourist

LIVE LIKE A RESIDENT

The best way to visit a country is to pretend you're moving there. New residents have more fun than tourists. Tourists go to museums, take pictures, eat at colorful restaurants, and do sightseeing. New residents do those things as well. But new